

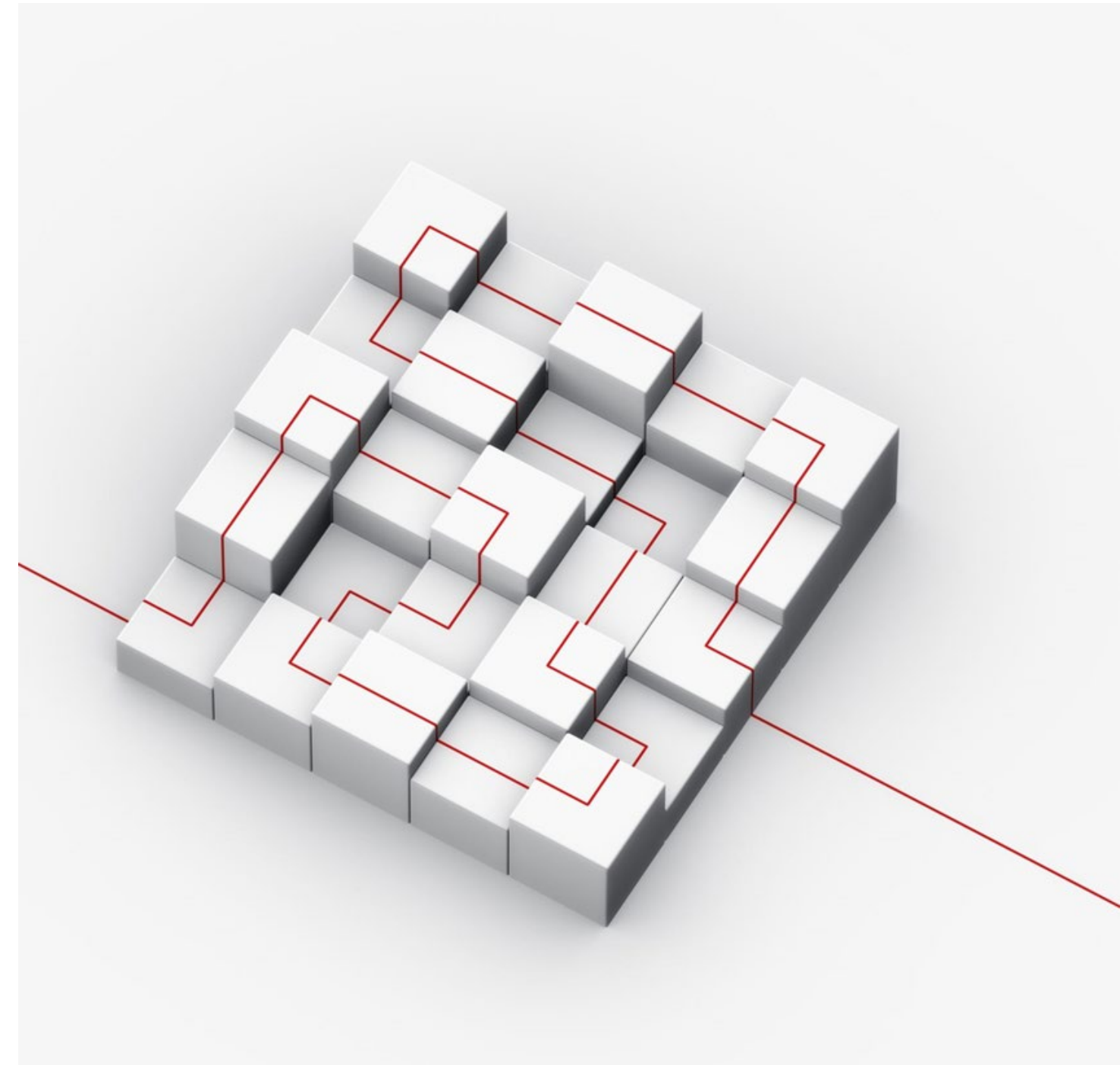
MGT0114 - Entrepreneurship

*Week 4: Key Drivers of Entrepreneurial Success in
Tech Sector, Concept Development*

Winter 2026

Plan for today

- **Schedule**
- **Assignment (Quiz)**
- **MVP Idea Generation**
- **Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice**
 - **Drivers to Success**
- **In-class Quiz**



	Theme & Learning Outcomes	Assessments (%)
Week 1 Jan 14	Intro to Entrepreneurship and Innovation	Journal 5%
Week 2 Jan 21	Entrepreneurship, Emerging Tech, Economic Growth	Journal 5%
Week 3 Jan 28	Types of Innovation, Problems and Solutions	Assignment 5%
Week 4 Feb 4	Success Drivers in Tech Sector, Metrics Project/Business Ideation	Quiz 5%
Week 5 Feb 11	Stakeholders in Entrepreneurship and Innovation, Early Adopters	Journal 5% Business/Project Idea 2%
Week 6 Feb 18	Business Goals and Vision, Market Research and Marketing Strategies	Marketing Assignment 5% Group Contract 2%
Week 7 Feb 25	Midterm Exam	Midterm Exam 20%
Week 8	Study Break Week – NO CLASS	

	Theme & Learning Outcomes	Assessments (%)
Week 9 March 11	Describe MVP, Business to Class Business Planning, Revenues, Costs	Informal MVP Update 2%
Week 10 March 18	Contract Negotiation	Informal MVP Update 2%
Week 11 March 25	Budgeting and Finance in IT Projects	Business/Project Plan Part I 7%
Week 12 April 1	Leadership and Organization Design	MVP Demonstration 8%
Week 13 April 8	Developing a Technology-focused Business Plan	Business/Project Plan Part II 7%
Week 14 April 15	Business Plan Presentations and Wrap-up	Demo and Plan Presentation 10% Self, Peer Evaluations 10%
Week 15	Final Exam Week (NO EXAM)	

Assessments

Assessment	Value	CLRs
Journals: Entrepreneurship	15%	1, 4
Quiz (In Class)	5%	1, 3, 4
Assignment – 5 P’s + 5 Personas	5%	1, 2
Written Assignment – Birth/Growth of Tech Company	5%	1, 3, 4
Midterm Exam	20%	1, 2, 3, 4
Business/Project Plan: Idea, Part I, Part II, MVP Demo	30%	2, 3, 4, 5, 6
Presentation, Self and Peer Assessments, Participation	20%	6

Hootsuite Profile



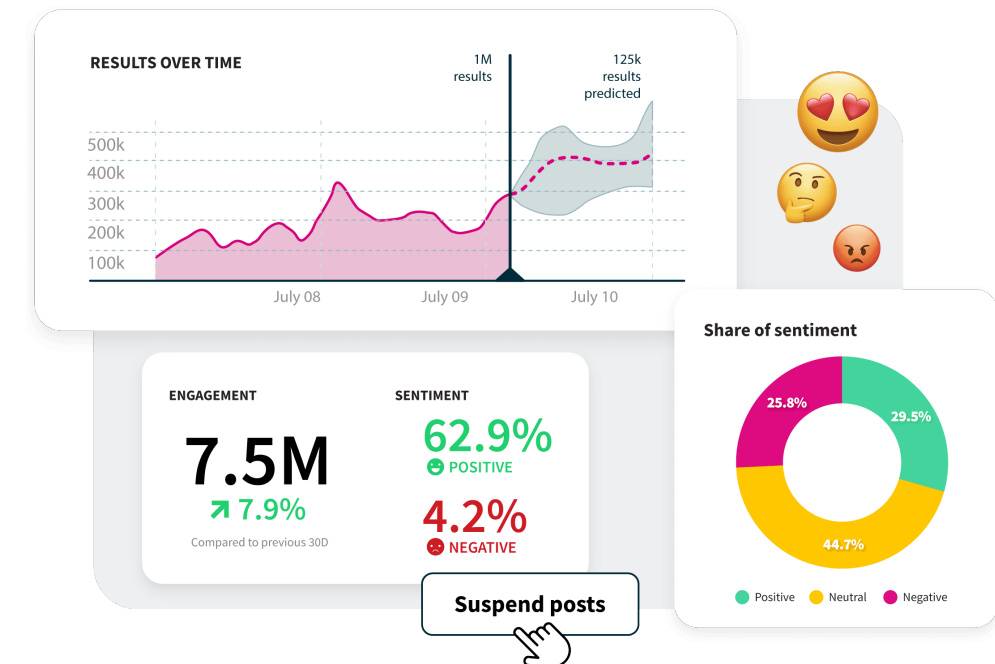
Founder & Background:

Ryan Holmes, Canadian programmer and serial entrepreneur (started businesses in high school, including pizza and paintball);

Founded via his digital agency Invoke Media.

How It Started:

2008 in Vancouver; Holmes built a prototype dashboard to manage multiple social media accounts for his agency clients; initially called BrightKit, launched as a free tool.



Hootsuite Profile



Product Progression:

Evolved from basic Twitter scheduler → full SaaS platform with multi-platform support (Facebook, Instagram, LinkedIn, etc.), analytics, team collaboration, social listening; added AI features, enterprise tools, and integrations over time.

Current State:

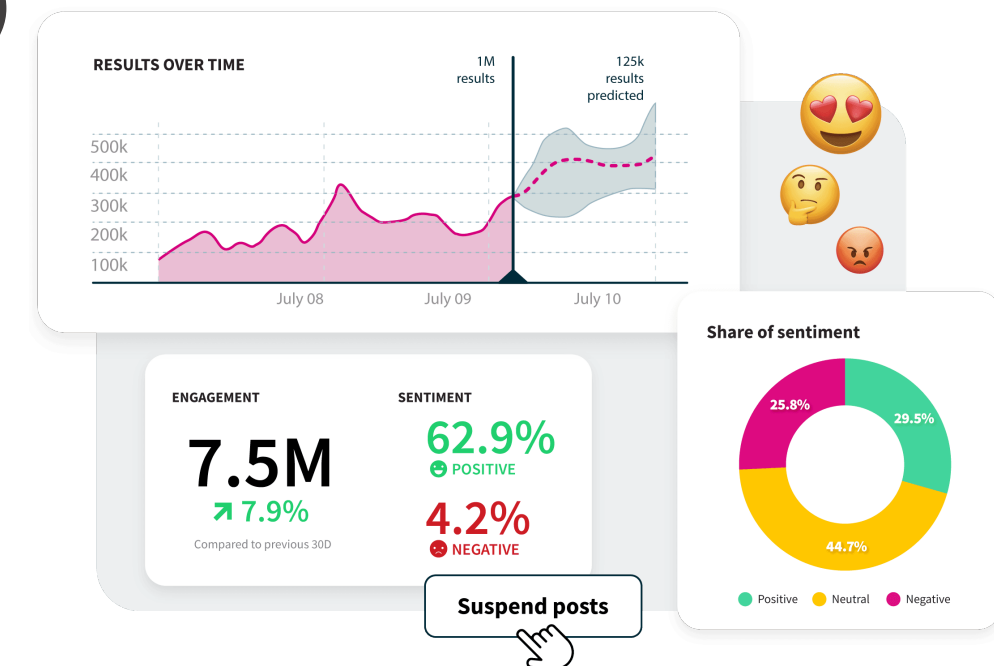
Leading social media management platform; 16–18+ million users worldwide; 1,000+ employees across global offices; profitable with focus on AI-driven trends (e.g., 2026 Social Media Trends report).

Hootsuite Profile



Keys to Success:

- Solved real pain point (multi-account management) with bootstrapped prototype.
- Freemium model → enterprise scaling for revenue.
- Early API integrations and adaptability to new platforms.
- Strong leadership, user feedback loops, and trend anticipation (e.g., AI, influencer tools).



Something to think about

"When in doubt, bootstrap. Using your own personal resources is the easiest way to start a business. You don't have to convince investors about the merits of your idea. You just have to convince yourself." - Ryan Holmes, Founder, Hootsuite

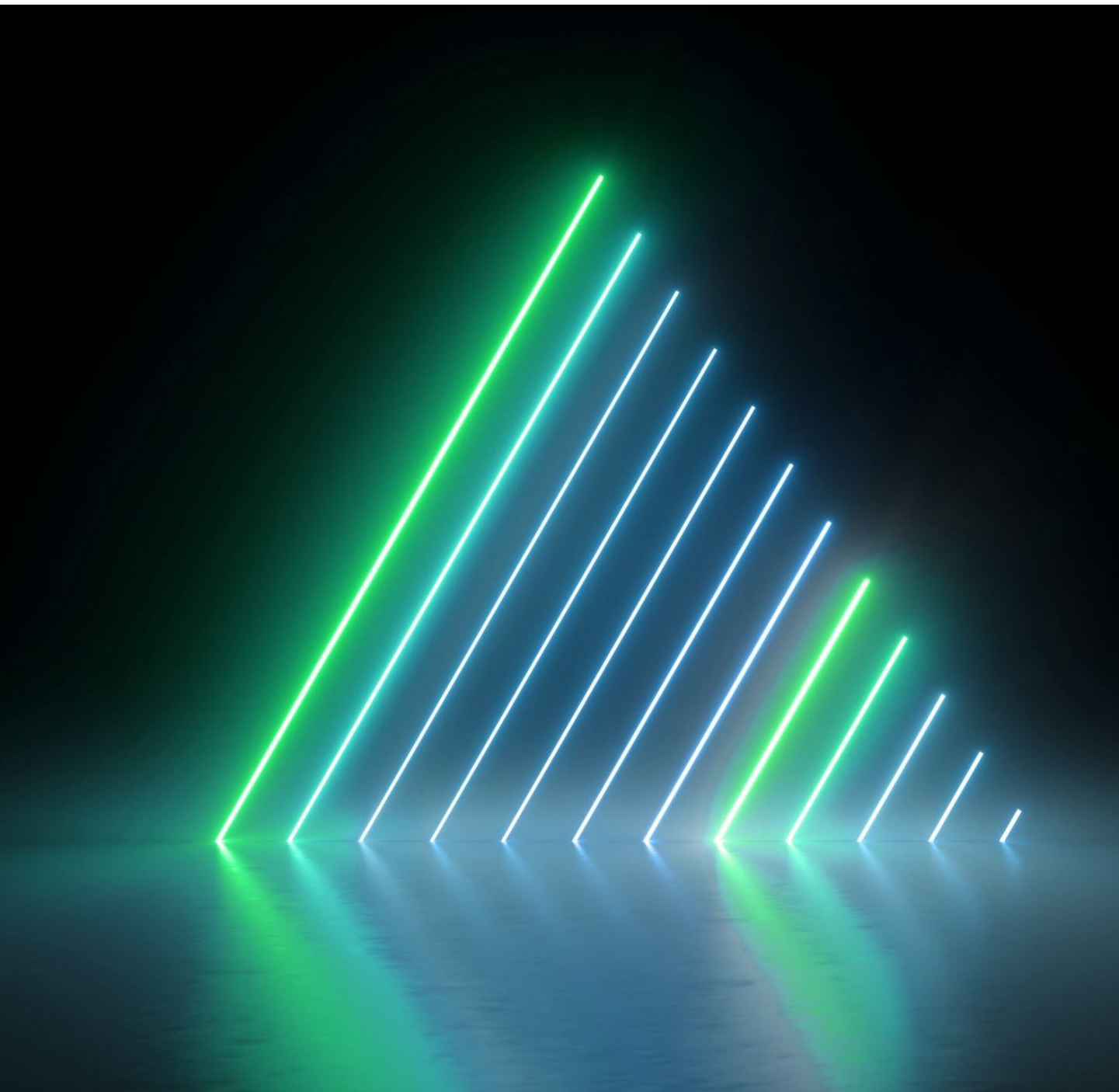


Assignment - Quiz

Quiz:

- Due: Today, 5pm
- Quiz on Brightspace
- Scope – Weeks 1 – 4

[Watch Priceless Advice from Entrepreneurs](#)



MVP Project for MGT0114

You (or you and your partner if you prefer) will:

- Select a project and business idea
- Develop a working, innovative MVP for this idea
- Develop a Business Plan using Lean Canvas for your idea
- Present your MVP and your product to the class



Idea Generation



Ideas for MVP Project for MGT0114

We will **Brainstorm** app ideas that could form the basis of a startup.

5 groups to develop a list of ideas.

Each idea should address a problem, have a target user, and be buildable as an MVP.

We'll aim for 6+ ideas per group, then vote on top 3



Ideas for MVP Project for MGT0114

First, Individual jot-down:

- List 3 apps you use daily and one frustration with each.

Next, 5 Groups.



Ideas for MVP Project for MGT0114

Each Group to develop 6+ ideas that can:

- Be an app (Android, Web, Apple)
- Solve a real problem
- Be the basis of a business
- Innovative
- MVP in 4-6 weeks

No criticism during ideation—quantity over quality at first. Encourage wild ideas, building on others, and diversity (e.g., C2C, B2C vs. B2B apps).



Ideas for MVP Project for MGT0114

Group 1: Problem-Solving Angle - "What app could fix a common issue in [campus life, remote learning, job hunting, fitness, shopping]?"

Group 2: Trend-Based: "How could AI/ML integrate into an app for [personal finance, mental health tracking, eco-friendly habits]?"

Group 3: Niche Markets: "Design an app for [programmers, students, small businesses, gamers] that [automates X, connects Y, tracks Z]."



Ideas for MVP Project for MGT0114

Group 4: SCAMPER Method: Adapt existing apps—Substitute, Combine, Adapt, Modify, Put to another use, Eliminate, Reverse (e.g., "Combine Uber with fitness tracking").

Group 5: User-Centric: Think of a persona (e.g., busy student, freelance coder) and brainstorm apps for their pain points.



Ideas for MVP Project for MGT0114

Share, with class:

- Top 2 ideas
- Absolute worst idea



Drivers to Entrepreneurial Success in the Tech Sector



Key Drivers



Innovation



Adaptability



Technical
Expertise



Access to
Capital



Network and
Partnerships

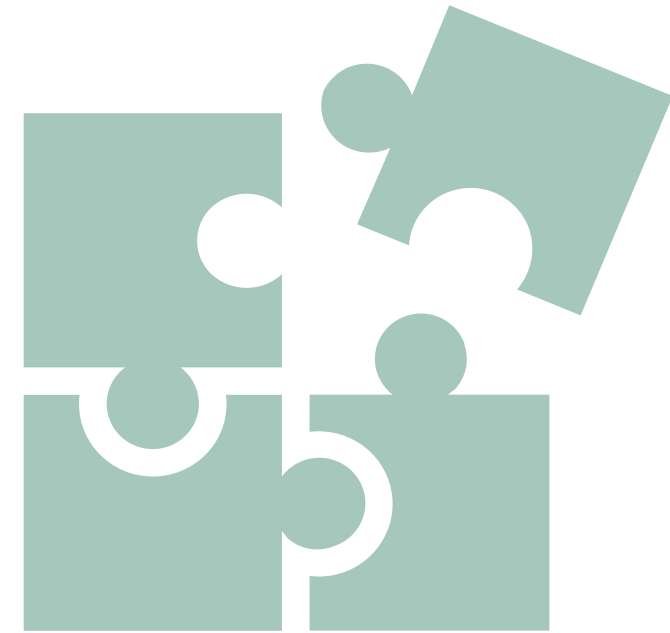


Market Timing

Innovation

Definition and explanation of the role of innovation in tech entrepreneurship

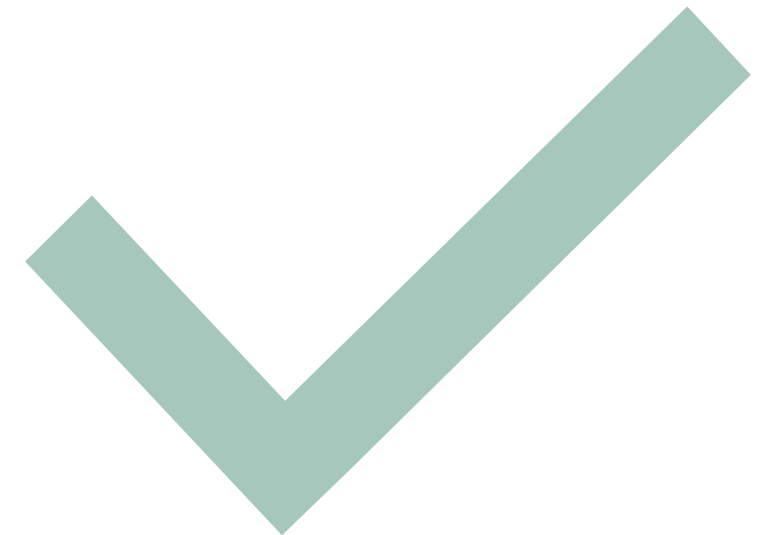
Case Study - How a real-world tech company leveraged innovation for success (e.g., Apple's iPhone)



Adaptability

The importance of adaptability in the tech sector

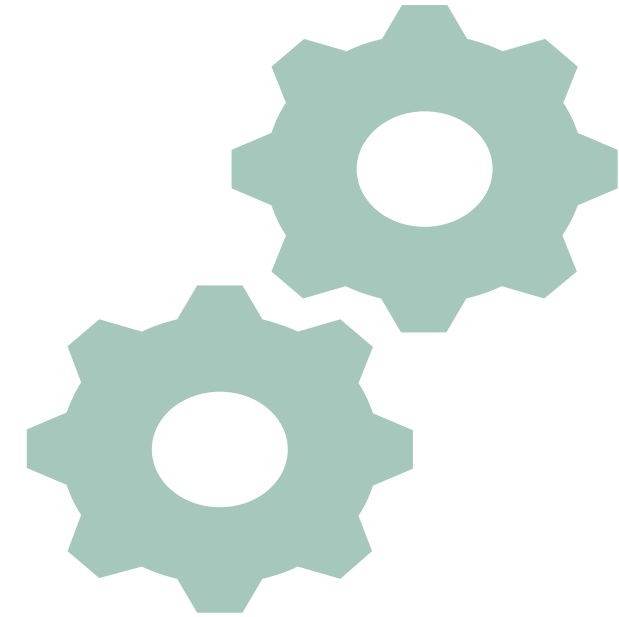
Case Study - A tech company that adapted successfully to change (e.g., Netflix's transition from DVD rental to streaming)



Technical Expertise

The role of technical expertise in driving success in tech entrepreneurship

Case Study - A tech entrepreneur who used technical expertise to build a successful business (e.g., Bill Gates)



Access to Capital

The role of funding in launching and scaling tech ventures

Case Study - A tech company that successfully leveraged venture capital or other forms of funding for growth (e.g., Uber)



Network and Partnerships

The role of funding in launching and scaling tech ventures

Case Study - A tech company that successfully leveraged venture capital or other forms of funding for growth (e.g., Uber)



Market Timing

Importance of launching a tech product or service at the right time in the market

Case Study - A tech company that achieved success due to well-timed market entry (e.g., Facebook)



Why Developers have an unfair advantage

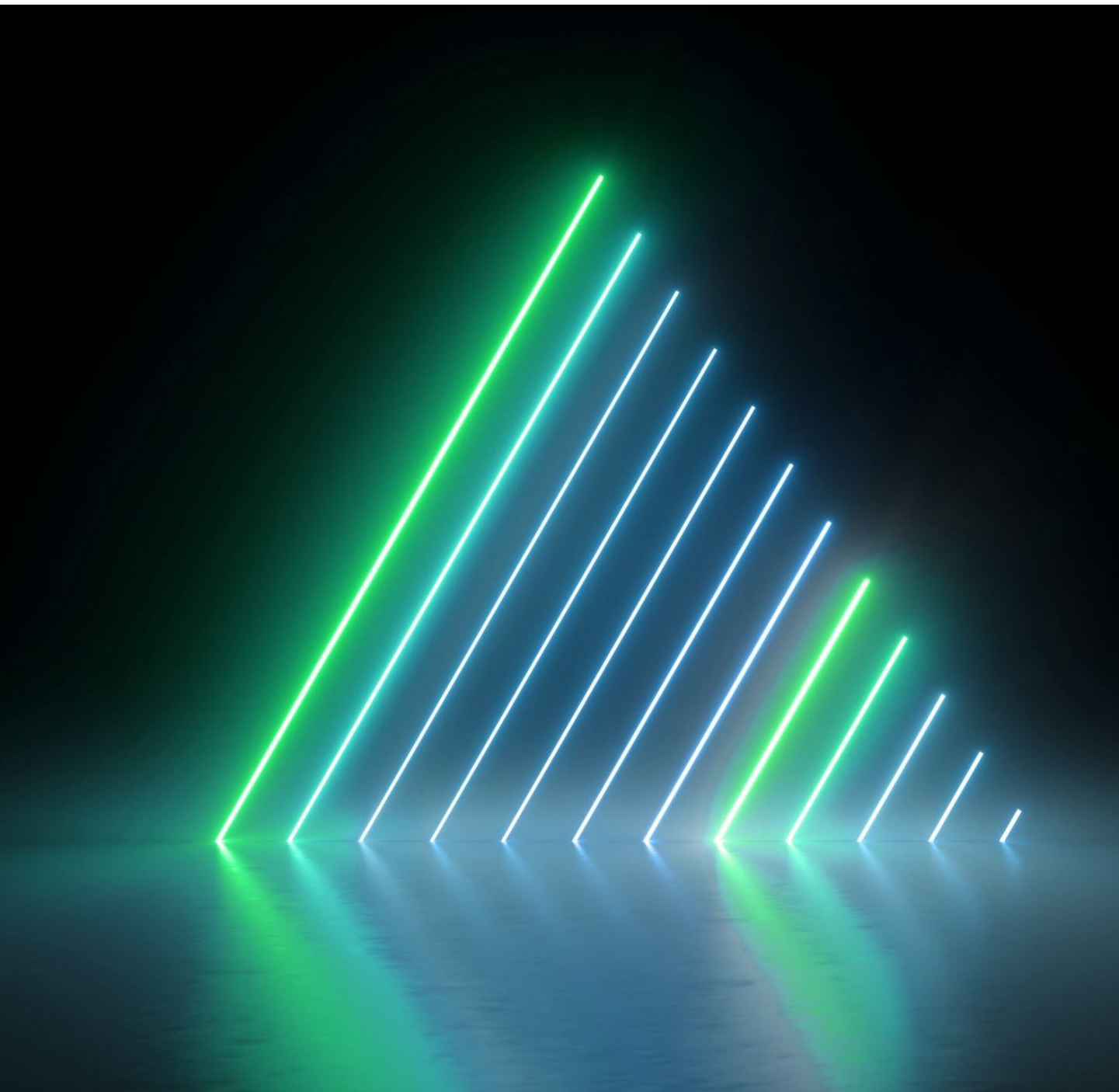


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